a means to hasten its dismantling and to draw scrutiny to other social and physical barriers in the United States and beyond.

By tracing the movements of these particular figures in and out of divided Berlin here, I seek a history of the Berlin Wall that encompasses a reckoning with U.S. power and presence in this divided city. I refer to "circuits of alternative cultural diplomacy" as an interconnected system of overlapping networks and practices of American culture in divided Berlin, which prompted ongoing visits from hundreds of artists, writers, thinkers, and activists and initiated a shadow roadmap full of detours and improvisations. Such circuits included mechanisms for state-sponsored activities and outcomes, as well as the rise of countercultural communities and expressive spaces beyond governmental oversight. In each case the subjects of this book navigated the spaces between two German diplomacies and critically negotiated their relationships to U.S. power by exploring geopolitical territory with a variety of creative tools. Some of these cultural circuits incorporated sites underwritten by U.S. diplomatic imperatives and sanctioned cultural visitors: the U.S.-backed Free University in West Berlin; state-sponsored programs of cultural exchange, including the German Academic Exchange Service (DAAD) and the Goethe Institute; and notable affiliated cultural venues, such as the Amerika Haus and Congress Hall.

In addition, this framework incorporates practices by those who deliberately worked on the margins of U.S. institutional support: Americans in Berlin who went to observe the close-up effects and social repercussions of ongoing military operations, those who built relationships of solidarity with radical communities and antiwar activists, and those who took part in cultural rites on the "other side of the Wall" as special invited guests of East Germany. This incorporative cultural framework is seldom used to group historical itineraries of visiting Americans to one or both sides of Berlin, enabling those who followed, strayed, detoured, or deliberately defied U.S. state-sponsored diplomatic projects to be considered together. The protagonists of this book not only circulated through such networks but also authored broader possibilities for engagement within the divided city and U.S. culture, thus shaping alternative diplomacies more broadly for West and East Berliners, as well as for Americans across multiple global sites. In this sense I also draw out the connections between prolonged military occupation and cultural preoccupations to examine legacies of militarized